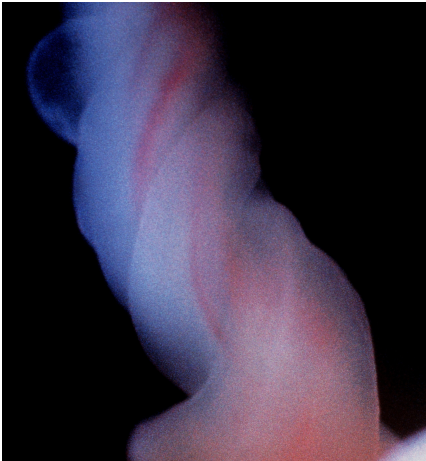




YOU ARE **12 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

191 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This image is a close-up of your baby's umbilical cord. The umbilical arteries can be seen as they carry blood from the baby to the placenta. Since there are no nerve fibers in the cord, your baby is unaware that this is happening—or even that the cord is there.

“You and your partner will be developing your own special relationship with your baby.”

At this point in your pregnancy, you won't be able to feel your baby move. It will also be a little while before your baby will be able to [hear](#) and recognize your voice and that of your partner, or hear other sounds, such as music. Nevertheless, some pregnant women still enjoy talking to their babies, feeling that it brings them closer to the baby; and it certainly does no harm! Do whatever feels natural to you, whether that is talking out loud or in your head.

You might want to think of an interim name for your baby. This might be “the bump” or “the bun” or an inside joke between you and your partner. It can be helpful to give your baby an identity because it's difficult to talk about them at this relatively early stage, especially given that in most cases you won't know the sex.

If you are still keeping the pregnancy a secret from people in some quarters, using a code phrase to refer to the pregnancy may be useful in some circumstances.

YOUR ACTIVE BABY

Your baby's many different movements are vital for his development. As your baby twists and stretches their body, flails their arms and legs, and moves their head, they're helping their skin grow and their bones, muscles, and joints to mature.

ACTIVITIES TO AVOID IN THE SECOND TRIMESTER

The second trimester is generally when fatigue lifts, and you begin to feel more energetic. This is a great time to continue your exercise program, making good use of your increased energy levels before you are too big and too uncomfortable to move and enjoy being fully active.

While you're encouraged to continue to exercise during the second trimester, there are some high-risk exercises that should be avoided. You should avoid any activity that potentially could cause you to fall, activities that involve a high degree of balance and agility, and specifically exercises that require lying on your back for extended periods, or twisting of the upper body.